
Irish Rail set to destroy planned East Cork cycleway — consultation closes 19 June

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Cc: Adrian o'sullivan <adrian.browndog@gmail.com>

Hi Cian,

I'm a resident in Ballyrichard, Midleton, Co. Cork, and I'm writing because Irish Rail's preferred route for a new depot access road would run directly through the corridor of the Carrigtwohill to Midleton Inter-Urban Cycleway Phase 2 — a strategically planned Cork County Council route that went through a full Part 8 planning process as recently as December 2023.

The route in question is Option 7, selected by Roughan & O'Donovan Consulting Engineers on behalf of Irish Rail for the CACR maintenance depot at Ballyrichard. It passes through the same agricultural landscape that the cycleway is designed to use. I'm attaching an Irish Rail engineering drawing — issued to us as affected landowners — which shows the cycleway running directly alongside the proposed depot access road. It's Irish Rail's own drawing. If Option 7 proceeds, it would bring HGVs, low-loaders, and 24-hour depot traffic through that corridor — making a safe, attractive cycleway functionally impossible.

A decade of planning for active travel infrastructure in East Cork — in a corridor that desperately needs it — would be undermined by a consultants' recommendation for a private staff access road that delivers no public benefit whatsoever. If Irish rail were to be granted planning for this, Cork County Council would be compelled to comply with the railway order.

The consultation closes on ****19 June 2026****. We're asking for Option 7 to be rejected and for a route that doesn't destroy the cycleway corridor to be selected instead. There are other options, avoiding the proposed cycle corridor entirely.

If you're able to cover this or share it with your readers, we'd be enormously grateful. The more voices Irish Rail hears from the cycling community before the 19th, the better. Our campaign site has the full technical detail, maps, and reference docs:

<https://no2option7.org/technical-evidence.html#ground9>

Main points again:

1. Character destruction — the cycleway was designed as a "traffic free route... segregated from vehicles" through "open agricultural lands." Option 7 turns it into a path alongside an HGV road.
2. Policy conflict — CMATS requires IU-1 to be "a fully segregated cycle track parallel to the rail line." Option 7 directly contradicts this national and regional mandate.
3. Democratic override — landowners cooperated with a proper Part 8 consultation process for the cycleway; the Railway Order mechanism bypasses Cork County Council (the cycleway's own commissioning authority) entirely.

Happy to answer any questions or provide further detail.

Many thanks,
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